Kai-Wen Hsiung

Senior Front-End Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Front-End Engineer with 8+ years building high-performance, scalable web applications using React.js, TypeScript, Vue.js, and modern JavaScript frameworks. Proven track record leading cross-functional teams and delivering measurable business impact: 20-30% faster user workflows, 45K+ daily active users, zero production incidents. Expert in responsive design, SSR optimization and A/B testing platforms. Recognized for technical leadership (Carousell 2024 Tech Toast Top Ambassador finalist) and award-winning data journalism collaborations. Skilled in bilingual (English/Mandarin) environments and mentoring engineering talent.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer(Front-End)

Carousell Group | Apr 2025 - Oct 2025 (7 mos) | Taipei, Taiwan (Hybrid)

- Owned List with AI – Image Flow web, integrating canvas-to-blob image processing with Carousell's server-driven UI architecture. Enabled ~75% of daily SG effective listings with MML at ~2-min P50 listing time - 20–30% faster than standard via AI-powered autofill. Delivered milestone on schedule, driving AI adoption for faster seller onboarding.
- Contributed to a projected US$72,100 yearly cost savings initiative by implementing educational components with various non-functional enhancements for a one-year chat message retention policy.
- Owned Category Browse pages SEO enhancements through cross-team collaborations and communications by correcting canonical URLs and patching missing features on mobile web. Led a detailed survey and RFC writing to introduce smooth, clear actions that contributed to the release of zero unexpected incidents on crucial buyer experience pages.
- Contributed to web platform technical non-functional migrations from adaptive web design to responsive web design for high-usage buyer experience components. Removed 8,000+ lines of legacy code by surveying component differences and consolidating duplicated branches through cross-team review, laying the groundwork for maintainability and developer experience.

Software Engineer 2(Front-End)

Carousell Group | Jun 2022 - Apr 2025 (2 yrs 11 mos) | Taipei, Taiwan (Hybrid)

- Promoted to Senior Software Engineer after consistently exceeding expectations in performance reviews (2 of 3 cycles), recognized for technical ownership and leadership.
- Project lead of the Buyer Experience team in a 5-team big rock project to launch unified checkout flow for Singapore and Malaysia - driving cross-platform API contract RFCs and cross-functional coordination across product, tech, data, QA from proposal to release. Enabled 25% of listings for cart purchases with 45K+ daily multi-item buyers and zero Sev-1 incidents post-launch. Recognized as 2024 Tech Toast Top Ambassador finalist.
- Mentored a web-engineering intern via weekly pairings and a structured onboarding plan, enabling 50+ production PRs in one term - boosting team velocity and earning multi-level recognition for multiplying team impact ("1 + 1 > 2").
- Drove Carousell 2.0 Certified Program (Luxury, Sneakers, Mobiles) as core web engineer - authored cross-platform API contract RFCs and UX refinements for 0-defect launches, laying the digital foundation for Carousell's expansion into 1P/3P e-commerce. Certified Mobiles achieved 33% average 14D STR, exceeding 50% for top merchants.
- Contributed to web platform technical non-functional migrations, including adaptive web design to responsive web design for better maintainability and developer experience; Enzyme to React Test Library migration to enable upgrade to React 18; CSR to SSR migration for page components to improve initial load performance; proposed and drove RFC of common features migration from client to backend to enhance maintainability; checked and enhanced CSS color tokens to enable dark mode.

Key Technologies: TypeScript, React.js, Redux Toolkit/Redux-Saga, Loadable Components, Jest/React Testing Library, CSS Modules, i18n, Protobuf, Git

Front-End Engineer

Mirror Media Co., Ltd. | Apr 2017 - Mar 2022 (5 yrs) | Taipei, Taiwan (Hybrid)

- Key member of readr.tw from early career - launched award-nominated data journalism projects collaborating closely with PMs, designers, and reporters, earned multiple national/international recognitions for social impact and storytelling, establishing cross-functional partnership as a core engineering skill.
- Led an end-to-end rebuild of mirrormedia.mg with Nuxt.js and SSR, improving Core Web Vitals by reducing the average page load time by 77% and the Lighthouse score from 17 to 70. Enhanced SEO for greater discoverability by reducing the number of poorly scored webpages in Google Search Console, and developed a premium paywall solution with custom authentication, enabling new digital revenue streams.
- Delivered audio platform mirrorvoice.com.tw as launch owner, architecting a custom audio player with Web Audio API - a foundation still in production today. Expanded company reach to new content formats.
- Led Google Optimize integration, enabling PM self-service A/B testing and reducing engineering dependency.

Key Technologies: JavaScript(ES6+), Vue.js(2.x), Nuxt.js(2.x), Express.js, D3.js, CSS Preprocessors - SASS/SCSS/Stylus, Google Analytics, Git

SKILLS

Frontend Frameworks & Libraries
React.js, Vue.js(2.x), Nuxt.js(2.x), Redux Toolkit, Redux-Saga, D3.js

Languages
TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+)

Testing
Jest, React Testing Library, Enzyme

Styling
CSS Modules, SASS/SCSS/Stylus, Responsive Web Design (RWD)

Web Performance & SEO
Server-Side Rendering (SSR), Core Web Vitals, Lighthouse Optimization, SEO, A/B Testing

API Architectural Styles
RESTful API, Protobuf, GraphQL

Tools & Platforms
Git, Google Analytics, Google Optimize, i18n

Soft Skills
Technical Leadership, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Project Management, Mentoring, RFC Writing, Code Review, Bilingual (English/Mandarin)

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science
National Chengchi University
Sep 2013 - Mar 2016 | Taipei, Taiwan

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
Taipei Municipal University of Education
Sep 2009 - Jun 2013 | Taipei, Taiwan

NOTABLE ACHIEVEMENTS

- Finalist, 2024 Tech Toast Top Ambassador at Carousell Group - recognized for outstanding ownership and cross-team leadership (LinkedIn post).
- Winner, SOPA Awards 2021 for Excellence in Information Graphics (Chinese Group), as front-end engineer for “5000 Fact-checking Reports Analysis: COVID-19 Disinformation War” (project), (award page).
- Nominee, Excellent Journalism Awards 2021 (Feature Story), as front-end engineer for “Chinese Slang Permeating Taiwan? Observing Youth Online Language Trends Through Dcard Data” (project), (award page).
- Nominee, Excellent Journalism Award 2021 (Creative Storytelling) (award page) and Sustainable And Constructive News Award (award page), as front-end engineer for “The Path of Transitional Justice...” (project); also recognized by Taiwan Transitional Justice Commission.
- Nominee, Data Journalism Awards 2019 (Best Breaking News), as front-end engineer for “Key 43 minutes: Illustrated Conversation Record of Taiwan's 2018 Puyuma Train Incident” (project), (award page), the only Taiwan-based finalist.
- Winner, SOPA Awards 2019 for Excellence in Feature Writing (Chinese Group), as front-end engineer for “The Dilemma of the Second Generation” (project), (award page); nominee, Tsang Hsü-pai Journalism Awards 2018 (award page).
- Winner, SOPA Awards 2018 for Excellence in Explanatory Reporting (Chinese Group), as front-end engineer for “Going Home Together: What's the Dispute Over Indigenous Traditional Territories?” (project), (award page).
- Led data visualizations and open data impact (project) as front-end engineer, creating social impact recognition by pushing regulatory change regarding political contributions as part of the g0v movement.